

Look, I'm not going to pretend that this isn't going to be a pain in the Quarter Pounder from time to time.

What I *am* telling you is that it will be worth it.

Besides, you drive your kid to basketball practice, right?

Well, chances are they're never going to make it to the NBA (just look at your husband's gene pool!).

So I want you to reframe your kid's part-time job and think of it as an extra subject at school.

However, in this class they're going to learn how to turn up on time, present themselves well, follow instructions, work hard, and get along with random people from different backgrounds. There will be no grades, but they'll certainly know the score, especially if their boss is a hard-arse.

That's an education unto itself.

I'd go as far as to say that any kid who finishes high school without having done at least some form of paid employment (even if it's over the summer holidays) hasn't had a well-rounded education.

It really is that important.

But I can't work! It'll affect my studies!

Maybe you don't share my passion for part-time jobs.

Maybe you're like the mother who once wrote to me saying that she wouldn't encourage her 15-year-old daughter to 'slave away' in a fast-food restaurant because the work was 'beneath her'.

Really, she actually wrote that. (My advice was that she should get her princess a job scrubbing toilets . . . and thank me later for all the money she'd save in therapy.)

Or perhaps you're worried that part-time work will impact your teen's schoolwork. Kids will throw this up as an excuse too: 'I can't work! It'll affect my studies!'